

DSAIL- HW7

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March 23, 2026

Problem 1

Let $P(i, j)$ be the maximum probability to reach $\text{post}(i, j)$ from $(1, 1)$. The subproblem is getting to (n, n) based on the previous move, either $(i - 1, j)$ or $(i, j - 1)$. We then have to multiply probabilities since the path is a product of the edge probabilities along the path.

Let $r(i, j)$ be the probability on the edge going right from (i, j) and let $d(i, j)$ be the probability on the edge going down from (i, j) .

The Cases for the problem are:

$P(1, 1) = 1$ Base case, The cat starts here

$P(1, j) = P(1, j - 1) \cdot r(1, j - 1)$ for $j > 1$, 1st row, can only arrive from the left.

$P(i, 1) = P(i - 1, 1) \cdot d(i - 1, 1)$ for $i > 1$, 1st col, can only arrive from above

$P(i, j) = \max(P(i - 1, j) \cdot d(i - 1, j), P(i, j - 1) \cdot r(i, j - 1))$ for $i, j > 1$ In this DP, the computation order for the table is row by row from left to right since we have information from $P(i - 1, j)$ and $P(i, j - 1)$. The Runtime is $O(n^2)$ since we have to fill in the table, each with 1 unit of work.

The Augmentation for the DP is to maintain a 2nd $n \times n$ table, that record the predecessor which achieved the max, so wither

$\text{choice}(i, j) = \text{down}$ if $P(i - 1, j) \cdot d(i - 1, j) \geq P(i, j - 1) \cdot r(i, j - 1)$

$\text{choice}(i, j) = \text{right}$ otherwise.

For the 1st row, $\text{choice}(1, j) = \text{right}$ for all $j > 1$. For the first column, $\text{choice}(i, j) = \text{down}$ for all $i > 1$.

To recover the path, we have to start at (n, n) and trace backwards to $(1, 1)$.

Problem 2

Part A

If there are only 2 people, and $f(1) = 1$, then $f(2) = 1/2$.

Since there are 2 people, and the 1st person choose a chair uniformly at random, there is a 50-50 chance they sit in the assigned seat. the 2nd person also has the same chance to get their assigned seat.

Part B

To build the recurrence we have to consider 3 cases:

Person 1 sits in their assigned chair, this has probability $1/n$. In this case all other people sit in the correct chairs so the probability that person n gets their seat is 1.

Person 1 sits in chair n with probability $1/n$. This means that everybody $2..n-1$ sits in their assigned chair, then when person n arrives, they sit in Person 1's chair. This is a guaranteed failure so the probability is 0.

Person 1 sits in chair j , where $2 \leq j \leq n-1$, with probability $1/n$. This means everybody $2..j-1$ sits in their assigned chair, then when person j arrives, they must pick another chair uniformly at random. Person j is analogous to another 'drunk person' so this is where this recurs, giving us $f(n-j+1)$. All together $f(n) = 1/n(1 + 0 + \sum_{j=2}^{n-1} f(n-j+1))$, but we can get rid of the 0 so

$$f(n) = 1/n(1 + \sum_{j=2}^{n-1} f(n-j+1))$$

If we let $k = n-j+1$, so j goes from 2 to $n-1$ and k from $n-1$ down to 2

$$f(n) = 1/n(1 + \sum_{k=2}^{n-1} f(k))$$

Part C

From Part A, we can use the $f(2) = 1/2$ as a guess, so $f(n) = 1/2$ for all $n \geq 2$

BC: $f(2) = 1/2$ which is trivial from the problem.

IH: assuming $f(k) = 1/2$ for all $2 \leq k \leq n-1$, we can use this later in the IS.

IS: We need to show $f(n) = 1/2$

$$f(n) = 1/n(1 + (n-2)/2) = 1/n \cdot n/2 = 1/2$$

Thus, $f(n) = 1/2$ for all $n \geq 2$

Problem 3

Part A

Let X be an indicator Random Variable where $X_i = 1$ means the node failed, and $X_i = 0$ means it passed. $E[X_i] = p$ for any i from $[1, n]$. Since we have n nodes, we can use LOE such that $X = X_1 + X_2 + \dots + X_n$ is the total number of failed nodes, thus $E[X] = np$

Part B

Markov's says $P(x \geq a) \leq E[x]/a$.

For this problem, $a = 1$ thus the Upper Bound for the Probability that at least One Node Failing is $P(x \geq 1) \leq np/1 = np$

Part C

Let E_i be the event that the node i fails. Then $P(E_i) = p$ for all i from $[1, n]$.

By the Union Bound $P(\bigcup_{i=1}^n E_i) \leq \sum_{i=1}^n P(E_i) = np$

This is the Upper Bound on $P(E_i)$ which is the probability that at least One Node Fails. For the Probability that No Nodes Fail we take the complement, and apply the bound

$$P(\text{No Fails}) = 1 - P(\bigcup_{i=1}^n E_i) \geq 1 - np$$

Problem 4

Part A

Let X_i be an indicator Random Variable, where $X_i = 1$ if row i is bad and 0 otherwise. Each node survives has probability $1-p$ so the probability that all nodes in a row, $\sqrt{n}$, survive is $(1-p)^{\sqrt{n}}$

Thus $P(x_i = 1) = 1 - (1-p)^{\sqrt{n}}$

Let $X = X_1 + X_2 + \dots + X_{\sqrt{n}}$ be the total number of bad rows. By LOE

$$E[X] = \sum_{i=1}^{\sqrt{n}} E[X_i] = \sqrt{n} \cdot (1 - (1-p)^{\sqrt{n}})$$

Part B

If there are exactly $n/2$ bad nodes, that are chosen uniformly at random from all n nodes, We can Let X_i be an indicator random variable where $X_i = 1$ if row i is bad and 0 otherwise.

Since exactly $n/2$ failed nodes are chosen uniformly at random, the probability that none fail in row i is

$$P(X_i = 0) = \binom{n-\sqrt{n}}{n/2} / \binom{n}{n/2}$$

Then we can take the complement so

$$P(X_i = 1) = 1 - \binom{n-\sqrt{n}}{n/2} / \binom{n}{n/2}$$

If we let $X = X_1 + X_2 + \dots + X_{\sqrt{n}}$ by LOE we get

$$E[X] = \sum_{i=1}^{\sqrt{n}} E[X_i] = \sqrt{n} \cdot (1 - \binom{n-\sqrt{n}}{n/2} / \binom{n}{n/2})$$